

Sandusky County Clerk of Courts

ADA / WCAG 2.1 Level AA — Accessibility Audit Report

Prepared June 2026 | Standard: WCAG 2.1 Level AA | ADA Title II Compliance | Platform: Materialize CSS (PHP)

10

FILES AUDITED

121

TOTAL FIXES

WCAG 2.1

STANDARD

AA

CONFORMANCE LEVEL

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1. nav.php — Site Navigation (included on all pages)

27 fixes

This file is included on every page. All fixes here propagate site-wide automatically once the file is updated.

#	Element	Issue	WCAG	Fix Applied
1	Skip link	No skip navigation link — keyboard users must tab through entire nav on every page	2.4.1	Added <code>Skip to main content</code> with show-on-focus CSS
2	Skip link CSS	No skip link stylesheet rules present	2.4.1	Added inline <code><style></code> with <code>position:absolute; top:-50px</code> and <code>:focus { top:0 }</code> pattern
3	<code><nav></code> top bar — <code>role="navigation"</code>	Redundant <code>role="navigation"</code> on <code><nav></code> element	1.3.1	Removed role; added <code>aria-label="Site header"</code>
4	<code><nav></code> main — <code>role="navigation"</code>	Redundant <code>role="navigation"</code> on <code><nav></code> element	1.3.1	Removed role; added <code>aria-label="Main navigation"</code>
5	Sidenav trigger <code>href="#"</code>	<code>href="#"</code> causes page jump to top on click	2.1.1	Changed to <code>href="#!"</code>
6	Sidenav trigger — icon only	Hamburger menu button has no accessible label — icon ligature only	1.1.1	Added <code>aria-label="Open navigation menu"</code>
7	Dropdown trigger #1 <code>href="#"</code>	Page jump on click	2.1.1	Changed to <code>href="#!"</code>
8	Dropdown trigger #2 <code>href="#"</code>	Page jump on click	2.1.1	Changed to <code>href="#!"</code>
9	Dropdown trigger #3 <code>href="#"</code>	Page jump on click	2.1.1	Changed to <code>href="#!"</code>
10	Dropdown trigger #4 <code>href="#"</code>	Page jump on click	2.1.1	Changed to <code>href="#!"</code>
11		Page jump on click	2.1.1	

#	Element	Issue	WCAG	Fix Applied
	Dropdown trigger #5			Changed to <code>href="#!"</code>
12	Dropdown trigger #6	Page jump on click	2.1.1	Changed to <code>href="#!"</code>
13	Dropdown trigger #1	Missing <code>aria-haspopup</code> and <code>aria-expanded</code>	4.1.2	Added <code>aria-haspopup="true"</code> <code>aria-expanded="false"</code>
14	Dropdown trigger #2	Missing <code>aria-haspopup</code> and <code>aria-expanded</code>	4.1.2	Added <code>aria-haspopup="true"</code> <code>aria-expanded="false"</code>
15	Dropdown trigger #3	Missing <code>aria-haspopup</code> and <code>aria-expanded</code>	4.1.2	Added <code>aria-haspopup="true"</code> <code>aria-expanded="false"</code>
16	Dropdown trigger #4	Missing <code>aria-haspopup</code> and <code>aria-expanded</code>	4.1.2	Added <code>aria-haspopup="true"</code> <code>aria-expanded="false"</code>
17	Dropdown trigger #5	Missing <code>aria-haspopup</code> and <code>aria-expanded</code>	4.1.2	Added <code>aria-haspopup="true"</code> <code>aria-expanded="false"</code>
18	Dropdown trigger #6	Missing <code>aria-haspopup</code> and <code>aria-expanded</code>	4.1.2	Added <code>aria-haspopup="true"</code> <code>aria-expanded="false"</code>
19	Material icon #1	<code><i class="material-icons"></code> ligature text read aloud by screen readers	1.3.1	Added <code>aria-hidden="true"</code>
20	Material icon #2	Same as above	1.3.1	Added <code>aria-hidden="true"</code>
21	Material icon #3	Same as above	1.3.1	Added <code>aria-hidden="true"</code>

#	Element	Issue	WCAG	Fix Applied
22	Material icon #4	Same as above	1.3.1	Added <code>aria-hidden="true"</code>
23	Material icon #5	Same as above	1.3.1	Added <code>aria-hidden="true"</code>
24	Material icon #6	Same as above	1.3.1	Added <code>aria-hidden="true"</code>
25	Orphaned <code>dropdown-titles</code> menu	Menu contains only <code>href="#"</code> placeholder links — no real destinations	2.4.4	Removed menu entirely
26	Orphaned <code>dropdown-titles2</code> menu	Same — mobile duplicate of above	2.4.4	Removed menu entirely
27	<code>id="main-content"</code> target	Skip link has no corresponding target anywhere on the site	2.4.1	Added <code>id="main-content"</code> to <code>.light-tan</code> wrapper on every content page

Client flag: `dropdown-clyde2` links to `FilingFees2013.pdf` (2013) while `dropdown-clyde` links to `25_court_costs.pdf` — verify which is current and remove the outdated file.

Client flag: `http://codes.ohio.gov/` uses HTTP — update to HTTPS if available.

2. index.php — Homepage

13 fixes

#	Element	Issue	WCAG	Fix Applied
1	<code><title></code>	Non-unique — all pages share "Sandusky County Clerk of Courts"	2.4.2	Kept as site identity title for homepage; unique titles applied to all other pages
2	Parallax <code>

</code>	Empty spacer elements used for layout	1.3.1	Removed both
3		<code>alt="Peaceful Tree Scene"</code> — decorative	1.1.1	Changed to <code>alt=""</code>

#	Element	Issue	WCAG	Fix Applied
	Parallax image	background image has descriptive alt		
4	<code>.light-tan</code> wrapper	Missing <code>id="main-content"</code> — skip link has no target	2.4.1	Added <code>id="main-content"</code>
5	Main content area	No <code><h1></code> in main content — parallax h1 may not be accessible in all contexts	1.3.1	Added <code><h1 class="sr-only">Sandusky County Clerk of Courts</h1></code>
6	Card image #1	<code>alt</code> text duplicates adjacent <code><h4></code> — double announcement by screen readers	1.1.1	Changed to <code>alt=""</code>
7	Card image #2	Same as above	1.1.1	Changed to <code>alt=""</code>
8	Card image #3	Same as above	1.1.1	Changed to <code>alt=""</code>
9	Card image #4	Same as above	1.1.1	Changed to <code>alt=""</code>
10	Card heading #1 <code><h4></code>	Heading jumps from h1 to h4 — skips h2 and h3	1.3.1	Changed to <code><h2></code>
11	Card heading #2 <code><h4></code>	Same as above	1.3.1	Changed to <code><h2></code>
12	Card heading #3 <code><h4></code>	Same as above	1.3.1	Changed to <code><h2></code>
13	Card heading #4 <code><h4></code>	Same as above	1.3.1	Changed to <code><h2></code>

CSS required in stylesheet:

`#card-sect h2 { font-size: 1.64rem; line-height: 1.3; margin: 0; }` — the `margin: 0` is critical; Materialize h2 default margins are larger than h4 and will break the parallax hero card overlap without this reset. Also add: `.sr-only`

```
{ position:absolute; width:1px; height:1px; padding:0; margin:-1px;
overflow:hidden; clip:rect(0,0,0,0); white-space:nowrap; border:0; }
```

3. pay.php — Pay Online

14 fixes

#	Element	Issue	WCAG	Fix Applied
1	<title>	Non-unique page title	2.4.2	Pay Online Sandusky County Clerk of Courts
2	Parallax 	Empty spacer elements	1.3.1	Removed
3	Parallax image	alt="Peaceful Tree Scene" on decorative image	1.1.1	Changed to alt=""
4	.light-tan wrapper	Missing id="main-content"	2.4.1	Added id="main-content"
5	Card image #1	Alt duplicates adjacent heading — double announcement	1.1.1	Changed to alt=""
6	Card image #2	Same as above	1.1.1	Changed to alt=""
7	Card image #3	Same as above	1.1.1	Changed to alt=""
8	Card image #4	Same as above	1.1.1	Changed to alt=""
9	Card heading #1 <h4>	Heading skips from h1 to h4	1.3.1	Changed to <h2>
10	Card heading #2 <h4>	Same as above	1.3.1	Changed to <h2>
11	Card heading #3 <h4>	Same as above	1.3.1	Changed to <h2>
12		Same as above	1.3.1	Changed to <h2>

#	Element	Issue	WCAG	Fix Applied
	Card heading #4 <h4>			
13	 inside heading	"Clyde Court County Court #1" — line break inside heading element	1.3.1	Replaced with em dash: <i>Clyde Court — County Court #1</i>
14	4 × external payment links	target="_blank" with no rel="noopener" and no new-tab disclosure	2.4.4	Added rel="noopener" + aria-label="... (opens in new tab)" to all four

4. docket.php — Online Docket

8 fixes

#	Element	Issue	WCAG	Fix Applied
1	<title>	Non-unique page title	2.4.2	Online Docket Sandusky County Clerk of Courts
2	Parallax 	Empty spacer elements	1.3.1	Removed
3	Parallax image	alt="Peaceful Tree Scene" on decorative image	1.1.1	Changed to alt=""
4	.light-tan wrapper	Missing id="main-content"	2.4.1	Added id="main-content"
5	"NOTICE" heading	Non-semantic bold/caps text used as heading — not announced as heading by screen readers	1.3.1	Changed to <h2 class="dark-sage-text">NOTICE</h2>
6	"NOTICE TO PROSPECTIVE EMPLOYERS" heading	Same — non-semantic bold/caps text	1.3.1	Changed to <h2 class="dark-sage-text">NOTICE TO PROSPECTIVE EMPLOYERS</h2>

#	Element	Issue	WCAG	Fix Applied
7	External docket link #1	<code>target="_blank"</code> with no <code>rel="noopener"</code> and no new-tab disclosure	2.4.4	Added <code>rel="noopener"</code> + <code>aria-label="... (opens in new tab)"</code>
8	External docket link #2	Same as above	2.4.4	Added <code>rel="noopener"</code> + <code>aria-label="... (opens in new tab)"</code>

5. titles.php — Title Office Forms

13 fixes

#	Element	Issue	WCAG	Fix Applied
1	<code><title></code>	Non-unique page title	2.4.2	<i>Titles Sandusky County Clerk of Courts</i>
2	Parallax <code>

</code>	Empty spacer elements	1.3.1	Removed
3	Parallax image	<code>alt="Peaceful Tree Scene"</code> on decorative image	1.1.1	Changed to <code>alt=""</code>
4	<code>.light-tan</code> wrapper	Missing <code>id="main-content"</code>	2.4.1	Added <code>id="main-content"</code>
5	12 × card images	Alt text duplicates adjacent <code><h4></code> heading — double announcement on all 12 cards	1.1.1	Changed all 12 to <code>alt=""</code>
6	12 × card headings <code><h4></code>	Heading jumps from h1 to h4 on all 12 cards	1.3.1	Changed all 12 to <code><h2></code>
7	12 × PDF download links	<code>target="_blank"</code> with no <code>rel="noopener"</code> and no PDF/new-tab disclosure	2.4.4	Added <code>rel="noopener"</code> + <code>aria-label="...(PDF, opens in new tab)"</code> to all 12
8		Plain text phone number — not a callable link	2.4.4	Converted to <code><a href="tel:4193349407"</code>

#	Element	Issue	WCAG	Fix Applied
	Phone (419) 334-9407			aria-label="Phone: 419-334-9407">
9	Google Maps link	target="_blank" with no rel="noopener" and no new-tab disclosure	2.4.4	Added rel="noopener" + aria-label="Get directions (opens in new tab)"
10	Address/ contact block	Address, phone, hours in plain <p> elements — no <address> element	1.3.1	Wrapped in <address style="font- style:normal;">
11	Orange <h1>	class="orange-text" over parallax photo — contrast may fail 4.5:1	1.4.3	Flagged for client — manual contrast test required
12	Fax (419) 334-4069	Info only — fax numbers should not use tel: links	—	Left as plain text (correct)
13	CSS reset for h2 in cards	Materialize h2 default margins larger than h4 — breaks parallax hero overlap	—	Added #card-sect h2 { font-size:1.64rem; line-height:1.3; margin:0; } to stylesheet

6. cp_fees.php — Common Pleas Filing Fees

9 fixes

#	Element	Issue	WCAG	Fix Applied
1	<title>	Non-unique page title	2.4.2	Common Pleas Filing Fees Sandusky County Clerk of Courts
2	Parallax 	Empty spacer elements	1.3.1	Removed
3	Parallax image	alt="Peaceful Tree Scene" on decorative image	1.1.1	Changed to alt=""
4			2.4.1	

#	Element	Issue	WCAG	Fix Applied
	<code>.light-tan</code> wrapper	Missing <code>id="main-content"</code>		Added <code>id="main-content"</code>
5	Table 1 — <code><th colspan="2"></code>	Section header missing <code>scope="colgroup"</code>	1.3.1	Added <code>scope="colgroup"</code>
6	Table 2 — <code><th colspan="2"></code>	Same as above	1.3.1	Added <code>scope="colgroup"</code>
7	Table 3 — <code><th colspan="2"></code>	Same as above	1.3.1	Added <code>scope="colgroup"</code>
8	All 3 tables — column headers	No column headers — screen reader cannot identify what each column contains	1.3.1	Added <code><th scope="col" class="sr-only">Description</th></code> and <code><th scope="col" class="sr-only">Amount</th></code> to each table
9	Footnote asterisk + <code><p></code>	Single <code>*</code> in table row vs <code>**</code> in footnote — mismatch; footnote not associated with table	1.3.1	Normalized to <code>*</code> ; added <code>id="fee-note"</code> <code>role="note"</code> ; linked table via <code>aria-describedby="fee-note"</code>

7. cp_forms.php — Common Pleas Online Forms

9 fixes

#	Element	Issue	WCAG	Fix Applied
1	<code><title></code>	Non-unique page title	2.4.2	<i>Common Pleas Online Forms Sandusky County Clerk of Courts</i>
2	Parallax <code>

</code>	Empty spacer elements	1.3.1	Removed
3	Parallax image	<code>alt="Peaceful Tree Scene"</code> on decorative image	1.1.1	Changed to <code>alt=""</code>

#	Element	Issue	WCAG	Fix Applied
4	<code>.light-tan</code> wrapper	Missing <code>id="main-content"</code>	2.4.1	Added <code>id="main-content"</code>
5	14 × static PDF links	<code>target="_blank"</code> with no <code>rel="noopener"</code> and no PDF/new-tab disclosure	2.4.4	Added <code>rel="noopener"</code> + <code>aria-label="...(PDF, opens in new tab)"</code> to all 14
6	Dynamic card links (PHP loop)	Same — <code>target="_blank"</code> with no <code>rel="noopener"</code> and no disclosure	2.4.4	Added <code>rel="noopener"</code> + dynamic <code>aria-label="<?= htmlspecialchars(\$forms[\$x]["Name"]); ?> (PDF, opens in new tab)"</code>
7	<code><h2 class="orange-text"></code> Supreme Court heading	Orange text on tan background — contrast may fail 4.5:1	1.4.3	Flagged for client — manual contrast test required
8	<code><?= \$forms[\$x]["PDF"]; ?></code>	Unescaped database output — XSS vulnerability (security, not WCAG)	—	Wrapped in <code>htmlspecialchars()</code>
9	<code><?= \$forms[\$x]["Name"]; ?></code> and <code>["Desc"]</code>	Same — unescaped database output	—	Wrapped both in <code>htmlspecialchars()</code>
Security note: Items 8–9 are not WCAG items. The <code>htmlspecialchars()</code> additions prevent reflected XSS if database content is ever compromised. Recommend flagging separately to your developer.				

8. contact_clerk.php — Clerk of Courts Contact

9 fixes

#	Element	Issue	WCAG	Fix Applied
1	<code><title></code>	Non-unique page title	2.4.2	<i>Contact the Clerk Sandusky County Clerk of Courts</i>
2	Parallax <code>

</code>	Empty spacer elements	1.3.1	Removed
3	Parallax image	<code>alt="Peaceful Tree Scene"</code> on decorative image	1.1.1	Changed to <code>alt=""</code>
4	<code>.light-tan</code> wrapper	Missing <code>id="main-content"</code>	2.4.1	Added <code>id="main-content"</code>
5	Contact info block	Address, phone, fax, hours in plain <code><p></code> elements — no <code><address></code> element	1.3.1	Wrapped all contact info in <code><address style="font-style:normal;"></code>
6	Phone link	<code></code> missing <code>aria-label</code>	2.4.6	Added <code>aria-label="Phone: 419-334-6161"</code>
7	Email link	<code>clerk@co.sandusky.oh.us</code> uses old county domain	—	Flagged for client — confirm if <code>@sanduskycountyoh.gov</code> is correct
8	Google Maps link	<code>target="_blank"</code> with no <code>rel="noopener"</code> and no new-tab disclosure	2.4.4	Added <code>rel="noopener"</code> + <code>aria-label="Get directions to 100 N Park Ave, Fremont, Ohio (opens in new tab)"</code>
9	Orange <code><h1></code>	<code>class="orange-text"</code> over parallax photo — contrast may fail 4.5:1	1.4.3	Flagged for client — manual contrast test required

Client flag: Email `clerk@co.sandusky.oh.us` uses the old `co.sandusky.oh.us` domain. Confirm whether mailbox has migrated to `@sanduskycountyoh.gov` and update both the `href` and display text.

9. contact_county.php — County Courts Contact

11 fixes

#	Element	Issue	WCAG	Fix Applied
1	<title>	Non-unique page title	2.4.2	County Courts Contact Information Sandusky County Clerk of Courts
2	Parallax 	Empty spacer elements	1.3.1	Removed
3	Parallax image	alt="Peaceful Tree Scene" on decorative image	1.1.1	Changed to alt=""
4	.light-tan wrapper	Missing id="main- content"	2.4.1	Added id="main- content"
5	Clyde card header <div class="card- header">	Div used as heading — not announced as heading by screen readers	1.3.1	Changed to <h3 class="card-header">
6	Woodville card header <div class="card- header">	Same as above	1.3.1	Changed to <h3 class="card-header">
7	12 × Material Icons	<i class="material- icons"> ligature text (call, print, person, etc.) announced by screen readers	1.3.1	Added aria- hidden="true" to all 12
8	Clyde fax <p>	Print icon aria-hidden but no "Fax:" text label — number loses context	1.3.1	Added Fax: prefix text
9	Woodville fax <p>	Same as above	1.3.1	Added Fax: prefix text
10	4 × phone links		2.4.6	Added aria- label="Phone: ..." and

#	Element	Issue	WCAG	Fix Applied
		Phone links missing <code>aria-label</code> (2 main + 2 probation)		<code>aria-label="Probation phone: ..."</code> respectively
11	2 × address blocks + 2 × map links	Contact info not in <code><address></code> ; map links missing <code>rel="noopener"</code> + new-tab disclosure	1.3.1 / 2.4.4	Wrapped each card's contact info in <code><address style="font-style:normal;"></code> ; added <code>rel="noopener"</code> + <code>aria-label</code> to both map links

CSS note: `h3.card-header { margin: 0; }` may be needed if Materialize's default h3 margins add unwanted spacing to the card header band. The `.card-header` class styling is unchanged — visual appearance is identical.

10. contact_title.php — Title Office Contact

8 fixes

#	Element	Issue	WCAG	Fix Applied
1	<code><title></code>	Non-unique page title	2.4.2	<i>Title Office Contact Information Sandusky County Clerk of Courts</i>
2	Parallax <code>

</code>	Empty spacer elements	1.3.1	Removed
3	Parallax image	<code>alt="Peaceful Tree Scene"</code> on decorative image	1.1.1	Changed to <code>alt=""</code>
4	<code>.light-tan</code> wrapper	Missing <code>id="main-content"</code>	2.4.1	Added <code>id="main-content"</code>
5	Contact info block	Address, phone, fax, hours in plain <code><p></code> elements — no <code><address></code> element	1.3.1	Wrapped in <code><address style="font-style:normal;"></code>
6	Phone link	<code></code> missing <code>aria-label</code>	2.4.6	Added <code>aria-label="Phone: 419-334-9407"</code>

#	Element	Issue	WCAG	Fix Applied
7	Google Maps link	<code>target="_blank"</code> with no <code>rel="noopener"</code> and no new-tab disclosure	2.4.4	Added <code>rel="noopener"</code> + <code>aria-label="Get directions to 500 W State St, Fremont, Ohio (opens in new tab)"</code>
8	Orange <code><h1></code>	<code>class="orange-text"</code> over parallax photo — contrast may fail 4.5:1	1.4.3	Flagged for client — manual contrast test required

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